

Unwind

How we didn't unwind this month, and really expensive holiday gifts that you can't afford

Community

In these pages we feature great articles, and other projects created by our Digit community of readers

WIN AT Trolling

Trolling, like most art forms isn't easy to master. Until now...

Mithun Mohandas

mithun.mohandas@digit.in

In the real world, throwing a nasty insult was often dealt with by use of physical violence. Sarcasm came as a natural evolution to the insult and it wasn't reciprocated with a punch (sometimes it was). The Internet brought along with it the gift of anonymity and all of a sudden the playing field was levelled. After a while, the insults were simply ignored and word-filters came became commonplace. The next step was to circumvent this by either using ASCII images or luring the victim onto a different domain, where the troll had more freedom. Anonymity, circumvention and baiting are still the pillars on which this dastardly skill stands.

Plan**Read the rules**

A proper execution of a trolling attempt relies on you being aware of what could go wrong. Every platform on the internet, be it Facebook, Yahoo! Answers, Quora or StackOverflow have their own set of rules which if violated ensures a quick swing of the ban-hammer. Take it from us, being ejected from a relationship and being banned feel pretty much the same, we know *sniff*.

Pick your target(s)

Start small. Pick someone or an audience that you believe can be easily trolled. This would



This could be you

mean that you need to beat these folks at their own game. You can't come up as a troll, rather you have to make them believe you're one of them.

Prepare

Preparation for a prank should be proportional to its scale. You can't troll the entirety of a forum based on something you cooked up in an hour. Let's say you've chosen to troll a popular anime fan forum. Just putting up a post that says, "OMFG! DOODs Korra is totally gonna die next season!!!" isn't going to elicit the attention you want. Instead, if you took the time to photoshop the character splayed on the floor with blood everywhere and posted that. Followed by two or three fake accounts (each in a different browser with a different proxy) all attesting to your post adds credibility. Then engaging other members and theory-crafting the possible scenarios around

the photo slowly starts making it seem a lot more believable.

For this prank, you had to:

1. Know photoshop
2. Create multiple fake IDs on the forum with a time gap of a few weeks.
3. Spend time and energy learning the lore and engaging your prey

You can probably guess that trolling at this level takes quite the effort. Using some esoteric term from the anime as your user ID on that forum would probably add weight to your opinion.

Learn

Your first few attempts at trolling are probably going to fail, some of you might not even bother after one or two tries. But, stop you mustn't! Failure is but a stepping stone to success. Practise aside, there are certain techniques which will aid you on making people believe your magnum trollus. Logical Fallacies are what you need to perfect. Very few can see through these methods and they always deliver. Don't know what we're talking about? Take a look at our politicians, one wonders why work never gets done. It's because they engage in argumentum ad nauseam, this means to repeat something over and over till nobody cares. Then there is reductio ad absurdum, reducing an argument to an absurd level that makes its converse seem true (e.g. cattle must fart or else they'd blow up from the pressure). There are a lot more fallacies which you can use to win arguments easily.

Troll

For a more comprehensive guide on how to troll people like a boss, go to <http://digit.in/winattrolling> 

